

# DESARAE MCNAIR

TECHNICAL PRODUCT  
MANAGER

## CONTACT

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## SKILLS

- Product:** Product Discovery • Product Strategy • Requirements Gathering • Roadmapping • MVP Planning • Agile • Stakeholder Management
- UX & Analysis:** User Research • HCI • Persona Development • User Journeys • Service Design • Process Improvement • Data-Driven Decision Making
- Technical:** Python • SQL • AWS • Azure • Machine Learning • Cybersecurity • Mainframe/COBOL • Technical Communication

## LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND CERTIFICATIONS

**IBM Z Student Ambassador** | Technical outreach, events, and student engagement  
**Vice President & Founding Member, LSAMP** | Student recruitment, STEM programming, and organizational development  
**U.S. Army, Motor Transport Operator** | 2013–2016  
**IBM Project Management Professional Certificate** — In Progress, Expected Dec. 2026

## EDUCATION

December 2025

### Master of Science (M.S.) in Computer Science

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

December 2023

### Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Cyber Security

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Product Management professional with a background in Computer Science, cybersecurity, machine learning research, and higher education. Experienced in user research, requirements gathering, UX strategy, stakeholder collaboration, and translating complex technical needs into practical product solutions.

## EXPERIENCE

September 2026 - Present

### Adjunct Instructor

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Design and deliver undergraduate instruction in **Mainframe Systems and COBOL**, translating complex enterprise computing concepts into practical learning experiences.
- Develop technical course materials, assessments, and hands-on activities aligned with learning objectives.

July 2024 - Present

### Academic Advisor

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Manage an advising portfolio of **572+ undergraduate students**, using student performance and engagement data to identify needs and develop individualized success strategies.
- Collaborate with faculty, administrators, and support services to resolve complex issues and improve student outcomes.
- Identify process and communication gaps and connect students with resources that support retention and degree completion.

January 2024 - December 2025

### Research Assistant

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

## TECHNICAL PROJECTS

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- **Neuro Adapt AI Product Strategy**

| UX Design | AI/ML

Designed an adaptive learning platform concept that uses AI to personalize educational experiences based on individual learning patterns, preferences, and interactions.

- **Student Job Connect Product Strategy | UX Design**

Designed a student employment platform prototype connecting college students with flexible, degree-relevant work opportunities through user research, persona development, and MVP feature planning.

- **Advising Hub Technical Product Management | UX Strategy**

Developed a centralized advising platform prototype inspired by the needs of 572+ students, focused on academic planning, communication, and student success.

- Developed machine learning models to analyze network traffic and identify **IoT cybersecurity anomalies**.
- Evaluated data patterns and refined algorithms to improve detection accuracy and model performance.
- Presented technical findings and translated research results into actionable recommendations.

January 2023 - December 2023

### **Equipment Specialist**

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Managed technical equipment projects from initiation through completion while coordinating requests, deliverables, and multiple stakeholders.
- Provided technical troubleshooting and support for hardware and software systems.